Bimser QDMS

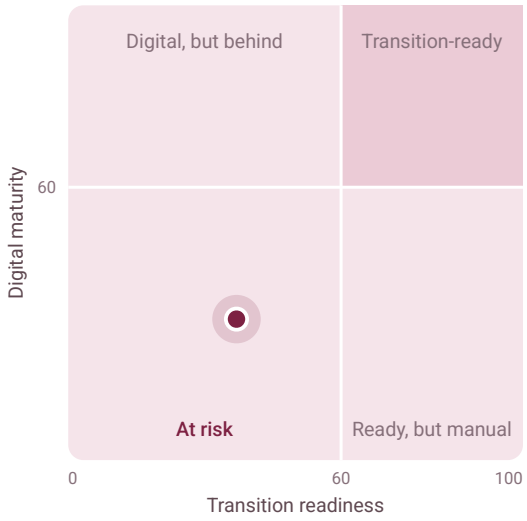
ISO 9001:2026 GAP analysis

Gulf Pharma LLC

3 October 2026 | Pharma / medical devices | 200–999 employees | Not certified

37
Transition readiness, of 100

31
Digital maturity, of 100



At risk

The new requirements and manual tools add up to a heavy transition. Start with a gap analysis now; 2029 is closer than it looks.

Readiness by area

Leadership and quality culture Clause 5.1 and 7.3	25
Risks and opportunities Clause 6.1	44
Context and climate change Clause 4.1 and 4.2	38
Change management Clause 6.3	50
Knowledge and documented information Clause 7.1.6 and 7.5	42
Transition planning Transition	25

Summary

6 major gaps

3 partial gaps

7 processes to digitalize

10 QDMS modules recommended

Exhibit 3 What changes in ISO 9001:2026

Clause	Change	What it means
5.1 · 7.3	**Quality culture and ethical behaviour**	Top management must promote both; organizations add quality culture and code of ethics documents and measure awareness.
6.1	**Risks and opportunities separated**	Risk management and opportunity management become two processes with their own criteria and registers.
4.1 · 4.2	**Climate change in the main text**	A topic once handled under environmental management (ISO 14001) is now assessed in the QMS context too.
6.3	**Change management strengthened**	Formal change management, once typical of IATF 16949 and ISO 13485, is now expected in ISO 9001.
7.1.6	**Organizational knowledge broadened**	Critical know-how must be identified, captured and kept available.

Exhibit 4 Clause-by-clause GAP analysis

Clause	Requirement	Score	Status	Process to revise
4.1 · 4.2	**Context, interested parties and climate change** Climate change now part of the main text	38	Major gap	Update the internal and external issues analysis and the interested parties register. Record whether climate change is relevant and which requirements it creates.
5.1	**Leadership, quality culture and ethical behaviour** Quality culture and ethics now expected from top management	13	Major gap	Add quality culture and code of ethics documents, link them to the quality policy and make leadership commitments visible.
7.3	**Awareness of quality culture and ethics** Awareness now covers quality culture and ethics	50	Partial gap	Add quality culture and ethics to awareness training and measure them with periodic surveys.
6.1	**Risk management** Risks now assessed separately from opportunities	50	Partial gap	Separate the risk methodology and register from opportunities. Keep process risk analyses (FMEA) current and track actions to closure.
6.1	**Opportunity management** Opportunities handled as a process of their own	38	Major gap	Create a separate opportunity register with its own evaluation criteria, owners and targets.
6.2	**Quality objectives and KPIs** No major change	25	Major gap	Link each quality objective to a KPI with an owner, a target and a review frequency.
6.3	**Planning of changes** Planning, communication and effectiveness review strengthened	50	Partial gap	Write a change management procedure: purpose, consequences, resources, approval, communication and an effectiveness check after each change.
7.1.6	**Organizational knowledge** Expectations broadened	75	Largely in place	Keep; check the wording against the 2026 text.

Clause	Requirement	Score	Status	Process to revise
7.5	**Documented information** Wording updated	25	Major gap	Review the document structure against the new wording. Ensure one approved version per document and fast record retrieval.
Transition	**Transition plan and audit** Old certificates expire 30 September 2029	25	Major gap	Approve a dated transition plan, run an internal audit against the 2026 edition and agree the transition audit date.

Exhibit 5 Digitalization points

Your quality processes run mostly on paper, Excel or shared folders. The 2026 edition adds requirements to each of them, so manual work and audit preparation time will grow.

Process	Today	Digitalization need	QDMS module
Documents and approvals 7.5	Shared folders / intranet	Medium	Controlled Document Management
Nonconformities and corrective actions 10.2	Excel and email	High	Corrective/Preventive Activity Management (CAPA)
Internal audits 9.2	Paper	High	Audit Management
Management review and KPIs 9.1 · 9.3	Excel and email	High	Action Management (incl. management review follow-up) Process Performance Management
Training and competence 7.2	Shared folders / intranet	Medium	Training Management
Supplier evaluation and customer complaints 8.4 · 9.1.2	Excel and email	High	Supplier Evaluation Complaint Management
Measuring equipment and calibration 7.1.5	Partly in a software system	Low	Calibration Management
Improvement suggestions 10.3	Paper	High	Suggestion Management

Exhibit 6 QDMS module roadmap

QDMS module	Priority	4.1	4.2	5.1	6.1	6.2	6.3	7.2	7.3	7.5	9.1	9.2	9.3	10.2	10.3	Trans.
Controlled Document Management One approved version of every document, automatic distribution and read tracking. The home for the new quality culture and code of ethics documents.				●						●						
Action Management (incl. management review follow-up) Tracks every action, meeting decision and transition task with owners and deadlines in one place.					●	●	●				●		●			●
Audit Management Plans internal audits against the 2026 edition, runs checklists on mobile and opens CAPA or actions directly from findings.												●				●
Suggestion Management Collects improvement ideas from staff, customers and suppliers, anonymous ones included. A natural feed for the opportunity register.				●	●										●	
Process Performance Management Links quality objectives to process KPIs with targets and trends, ready for management review.						●					●		●			
Training Management Plans training per position, runs a competence gap analysis and measures training effectiveness, including quality culture and ethics awareness.								●	●							
Risk Management (corporate, process, FMEA) Adapts to your risk methodology, keeps risk history and heat maps, and links measures to CAPA and actions.		●	●		●											
Opportunity Management A separate opportunity register with its own criteria, owners and targets, as the 2026 edition now treats opportunities apart from risks.					●											
Environmental Issues and Impacts Assesses climate-related and environmental issues so the context analysis of the QMS can reference them.		●	●													
Corrective/Preventive Activity Management (CAPA) Records nonconformities with root cause analysis and tracks each action to an effectiveness check. Linked to risk, audit and complaints.					●									●		

A dot means the module supports that ISO 9001:2026 clause. The bar shows priority based on the size of your gaps.

Also worth considering later: Change Management, Survey Management, Supplier Evaluation, Complaint Management

Next steps

Book a 30-minute session with a QDMS transition specialist to turn this analysis into a transition and module plan for your organization.

Book a 30-minute session: https://bimser.com/en/

This is a self-assessment for orientation. It does not replace a certification audit or a professional gap analysis. Questions are written by Bimser and paraphrase the topics of ISO 9001:2026; they do not reproduce the standard. Transition deadline per accreditation guidance: 30 September 2029.